

SETH JEFFERY

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16 Stiles Avenue, Marple, SK6 6LR, United Kingdom

Skills

Overview: 20+ years' professional experience. A highly competent senior-level developer and team lead, with a flair for AI tools and UX. I am well-known for my excellence in engineering high-level solutions and then delivering on them swiftly, whether independently or overseeing a small team.

Languages/Systems:

-  **CODE** — Typescript, NodeJS, NextJS, React, Ruby-on-Rails, Serverless, Vite, Python, C#, Go, Javascript, Objective-C, PHP.
-  **STYLE** — Styled Components, TailwindCSS, Emotion, MaterialUI, Storybook, CSS Modules, SVG/Vector, Photo editing.
-  **ARCHITECTURE** — AWS, Azure, Netlify, Vercel, Heroku, Terraform, GCP.
-  **AI** — Claude, OpenAI/Codex, Cursor, Stable Diffusion.
-  **MUSIC** — [More than a hobby, non-work professional skills also make us who we are and affect how we work.] Music production, Drums, Guitar, Keys, Mainstage, Piano, Saxophone, Orchestral composition.

Experience

TMA Systems

Staff Engineer

Nov 2025 – Present

As tech lead of the AI team, I led architecture and development of new AI-driven products for the company, particularly the new OTTO AI chat assistant. Being a staff engineer meant force-multiplying my immediate and wider teams by:

- conducting a series of company-wide seminars on AI-assisted development, vibe-coding and how to use LLMs more effectively, resulting in a greater adoption of AI practices across the whole company;
- introducing cross-team AI collaboration channels, architecture proposal templates, SOPs, and a COE process, improving cross-team knowledge sharing;
- introducing a UI/UX tiger team and design system to establish higher quality components with clear front-end development patterns, reducing time wasted from brand ambiguity;

- writing marketplace Claude skills for onboarding, deployment with versioning and release notes generation, ticket-to-production, PR auto-review, and comment addressing;
- bringing regular team demos (and pushing for cross-team demo days) to maintain cognitive proximity to LLM-written code, so that development time is greatly reduced without sacrificing understanding of the project.

Varsity Tutors

Staff Engineer

April 2023 – Nov 2025

Senior Software Engineer

March 2018 – April 2023

I helped the company transition through COVID adopting a 100% online tutoring business, achieving IPO, and seizing the opportunities presented through AI. I helped drive growth through a multitude of accomplishments:

- building a custom internal web stack for content creators to author websites in pure YAML without technical expertise, expediting landing page delivery and lead gen;
- architecting an internal cache proxy that increased site performance and redundancy, driving \$6M annualized revenue;
- migrating numerous internal and public-facing sites (PHP → Ruby-on-Rails, RoR → React and Typescript, Monolith → SOA);
- pioneering end-to-end Playwright testing as a North Star across our engineering department, improving our reliability and speeding up CI/CD;
- becoming a key mentor for the engineering dept in AI-assisted development through webinars and building an internal MCP Server to speed up the workflow of engineers and product managers.

Marks & Spencer Venture Lab

Contractor, Ruby-on-Rails / React

September 2017 – March 2018

I joined the team as a full-stack contractor building a greenfield system to integrate M&S food offerings with personal lifestyle tracking.

Stafford Long & Partners

Contractor, Ruby-on-Rails

June 2017 – September 2017

I contracted for Stafford Long & Partners, doing full-stack Ruby-on-Rails development. Focusing on migration, TDD, and upgrading the codebase for their Barclays CMS solution.

Quipper

Technical Manager

April 2014 – May 2017

Ruby Developer

June 2017 – September 2017

I helped build out the company's primary educational system providing gamified learning, resulting in the company's successful acquisition for \$39M. I spearheaded most of the development, eventually becoming team lead under the CTO, where I managed engineers in UK and in Mexico remotely.

BBC

Test Engineer

November 2011 – March 2012

I worked in the Future Media department of the BBC, writing regression and end-to-end tests in Ruby with Cucumber, with a focus on the core services of BBC iPlayer.

Seth Jeffery Ltd

Self-employed

September 2010 – November 2011

IMD Plc

Software Developer

October 2006 – September 2010

Developing and designing websites in Microsoft technologies, as well as creating Windows services to perform file transfers and tasks. Administering and optimising database queries for Microsoft SQL Server 2005. Programming in C# 2.0/3.0, ASP.Net, HTML, CSS, JQuery.

Education

Northbrook College

Bachelor's degree: Music production

2001 – 2004

As an accomplished musician, I originally wanted to be a film composer. Instead, I was noticed by a software company due to the games I was coding at home, so was offered a new career path.

Personal Projects

Eduventure Game

AI-powered choose-you-own adventure with a focus on education

<https://eduventure-game.vercel.app/>

Pocket Bunnies

Chores management app for my family

<https://www.pocketbunnies.com/>

Music

Spotify – 5 albums, 4 singles

<https://open.spotify.com/artist/2EW1MEqM5vrQCcbQPyfeNT>